

Chapter 73-4

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That same night, a quarrel also erupted at the Liang family villa.

After dinner ended, Sun Meirou took Ling Dang upstairs to wash up. Yu Wan had been especially prone to drowsiness lately. After saying goodbye to everyone, she went upstairs to rest.

Only the two Liang brothers and the Liang couple remained.

Qiu Zimin sat weakly on the sofa watching the news, while Father Liang and the Liang brothers went to the study to discuss company matters.

It wasn't until after nine o'clock that Qiu Zimin had a servant cut fruit, then personally delivered it to the study door, where she heard Father Liang talking to someone: "Are you certain? Those two people are from Taoyuan County¹? Then what about my daughter? Is she still there now?"

"What do you mean? They're all dead?" Just as Father Liang finished speaking, Qiu Zimin pushed open the door and said sternly: "Who died? Is my Nuan Nuan already dead?"

Father Liang waved his hand signaling her to calm down and continued talking with the person on the other end of the phone.

Liang Xinzhou and Liang Xinhe exchanged glances, both seeing helplessness in each other's eyes.

They'd said every good and bad word possible, but this couple just wouldn't listen.

Finding their biological daughter had become their obsession.

Last time when Liang Shi brought Xu Qingzhu home for dinner, it also ended unpleasantly.

This family seemed to automatically exclude Liang Shi.

This left both Liang brothers feeling speechless yet powerless.

The strange atmosphere continued until Father Liang finished his call. As soon as he hung up, he found Qiu Zimin already in tears. He said helplessly: "What are you doing?"

"Our Nuan Nuan....." Qiu Zimin sobbed quietly, "Is she really dead?"

"She's not dead." Father Liang frowned and sighed lightly: "Her family is all dead."

Qiu Zimin immediately perked up. Father Liang had Liang Xinhe open his phone. Liang Xinhe was bewildered: "What for?"

"Open that thing called Weibo²." Father Liang said, "That app. Search for Guo Xinran."

Liang Xinhe: "....."

"Xin is the 'xin' from 'xinwei'³, ran is the 'ran' from 'ranhou'⁴." Father Liang urged: "Hurry up."

Liang Xinhe was under pressure. Just as he was about to unlock his phone, Liang Xinzhou pressed it down. He looked at Father Liang: "Do you still remember what I told you?"

"I can understand you favoring Liang Shi, but the problem is your biological sister has no one left around her." Father Liang looked at him, "Liang Xinzhou, are you really that heartless?"

Liang Xinzhou's expression stiffened. He adjusted his glasses: "Can you come up with a strategy to protect everyone?"

"You're right, there will inevitably be sacrifices." Father Liang said in a heavy voice: "Just let....."

Qiu Zimin spoke first: "Sacrificing Liang Shi will do. This family is the same with or without her. She's an ungrateful wretch⁵. Now she's even turning around to bite me. I'm already putting the Qianshui Bay villa up for sale. From now on, she shouldn't associate with the Liang family—bad luck."

Qiu Zimin looked at the two brothers with reddened eyes: "I'm telling you both, if you have any brotherly love, show more care for your biological sister! Can't you hear? Your biological sister is suffering. You're all heartless people."

As she spoke, she ran out to get her own phone, then searched for that name in the living room. She saw her pinned Weibo post and those posted photos. She stumbled back to the study, then said to Father Liang: "It's her, it's her."

Father Liang was currently in a standoff with the Liang brothers.

Liang Xinhe's opinion was that they could have both. Liang Xinzhou's meaning was to just give money and not bring the person back.

Father Liang clearly agreed more with Liang Xinhe's opinion, but also implicitly suggested giving Liang Shi her own business, just giving Liang Shi a sum of money to make her disappear from public view and stop associating with the Liang family.

Meanwhile, Qiu Zimin was still in shock from finding her daughter. Seeing the three of them with gloomy faces in confrontation, her anger flared up. She pointed at the Liang brothers and said furiously: "That's your biological sister! What is Liang Shi? We raised her well enough! What are you doing now? Are you going to sever ties with the Liang family for her sake?"

"Mom, you're being too extreme." Liang Xinhe came out to mediate: "Aren't we discussing a better strategy? Liang Shi can stay, and that sister can be brought back too."

"I still say the same thing—bringing her back makes her a ticking time bomb." Liang Xinzhou said: "Who knows when she'll blow up our entire family."

"You haven't even met her in person, how can you be so arbitrary?!" Qiu Zimin said sternly: "Liang Xinzhou, I think you've been bewitched by Liang Shi!"

"This has nothing to do with her as a person." Liang Xinzhou stood up, looking down at Qiu Zimin. After thinking for two seconds, he said coldly: "It's your attitude that tells me."

Liang Xinzhou said: "Look at yourself now, and your recent behavior. Ever since you argued with Liang Shi, you've been like this every day. If you found your biological daughter, you would definitely make everyone yield to her, but I'm not willing to let my family yield to her, even if she's suffered and struggled outside for many years."

"Slap—"

Qiu Zimin slapped Liang Xinzhou across the face, directly knocking off his glasses. She screamed: "Liang Xinzhou, are those human words coming out of your mouth?!"

"Why are you so selfish?!" Qiu Zimin demanded: "That's your biological sister! She nearly died outside all these years, and it's not right for the whole family to yield to her? What kind of spell has Liang Shi cast on you to make you hate me like this? Do you want to replace me as your mother too?!"

Liang Xinzhou was stunned for a moment.

Then he looked at Qiu Zimin coldly.

That cold gaze made Qiu Zimin shiver, suddenly realizing what she had just done.

Qiu Zimin's hand trembled slightly.

Had she hit her son who was this grown?

Hit for the first time this son who had made her incredibly proud since childhood?

Liang Xinzhou's voice nearly froze into ice as he said in a low voice: "These years, you and Father know in your hearts what you've done to Liang Shi. You used her, then you want to throw her away."

Liang Xinzhou curved his lips in a cold smile: "Then bring your biological daughter back. Fine, go ahead."

"She comes back, I move out." Liang Xinzhou said: "This is your home, do as you please."

A naked threat.

"Liang Xinzhou, you!" Qiu Zimin was about to reprimand him when Liang Xinzhou had already stepped on his own glasses and walked out, leaving only his back view.

Liang Xinhe said helplessly: "I'll go try to persuade him."

After saying this, he also left the study.

But after they left, Qiu Zimin looked at Father Liang and suddenly covered her face and wept bitterly: "What sins have I committed?"

Father Liang was silent for a moment, then sighed: "Let's find Nuan Nuan first."

Footnotes:

¹ Taoyuan County (桃源县): A county name, literally means "Peach Blossom Spring County," referencing the famous Chinese literary work about an isolated utopia.

² Weibo (微博): China's equivalent of Twitter, a major social media platform for microblogging.

³ Xinwei (欣慰): Meaning "gratified" or "relieved"—Father Liang is using this word to indicate which character "xin" (欣) to use.

⁴ Ranhou (然后): Meaning "then" or "after that"—Father Liang is using this to indicate which character "ran" (然) to use.

⁵ Ungrateful wretch/white-eyed wolf (白眼狼): A Chinese idiom referring to someone who is ungrateful and betrays those who helped them, like a wolf that cannot be domesticated and will turn on its benefactors.